

Identifying Spirit, Soul and Body

We have found out that the four basic ways God communicates with His children are, first, through the inner witness. That is the primary way He leads the majority of His children.

Second, He communicates by revelation. That is the way I like Him to communicate best. Revelation is like God downloading an entire revelation onto a computer chip, sending it from His Spirit to your spirit, and releasing the whole program suddenly. Because your spirit has the capacity to understand and operates in God's class, you suddenly know. Sometimes I receive enough revelation in a millisecond that it takes months to preach it out.

Third, He will speak your language to you. He will say something in your spirit in the language you understand. Most of the time when we interpret a prophecy, God will speak the first sentence to you and you will hear it.

For years I prophesied in King James because if He did not speak to me in King James, I did not believe it was Him. The day He broke me from that, He asked, "How do you think the Japanese prophesy?" From that day, when He prophesied through me in English, He changed to the language I use.

The fourth way He communicates is by vision.

One kind of vision is an open vision, when suddenly the room disappears and is replaced by a full vision. Nothing is there but the vision. You feel as though you are standing in it and looking right into it.

One time I saw Jesus in an open vision during the great controversy over Kenneth Copeland's teaching "From the Cross to the Throne." Copeland preached about Jesus' descent into the lower parts of the earth, His spiritual death, and His being the firstborn of many brethren. It sparked a great controversy over what people called the JDS heresy.

At the time I was not fully settled because I was riding on someone else's revelation. In the middle of preaching, just before I got Jesus out of that deep, dark place, I went into a full vision. One moment I was looking at the crowd; the next moment I was staring at a man lying flat on his back in a dark concave. His body was covered to the point that he looked deformed.

There was movement on his body. When I looked closer, the movement was worms, several of them, like the place of outer darkness where there is gnashing of teeth and their worm dies not.

He was either a sufferer in your place or He was not. If He suffered in your place, then He had to suffer the penalty for going there.

When I came out of the vision, I was stunned. To the people, the whole thing happened in a millisecond. I paused, stared blankly, and then came out of it. I said, "Lord, You have to understand: it was You I had down there. According to Psalm 88, it was You I put in the lower

parts of the earth. Are You telling me this was You?"

It was so shocking that I needed Scripture on it, and He gave me Scripture.

Another time I had an open vision when a holiness woman with a dress down to her ankles had a growth cutting off the main artery in her leg. You could not see it because of the dress. Suddenly, when I was getting ready to pray for her, everything disappeared except a pair of legs suspended in front of me. I saw the growth blocking the main artery. I reached down through her dress just above her ankle, put my finger on the growth, and it died.

Another morning I woke up thinking I was opening my eyes to the bedroom, but instead I opened them to a full vision that acted itself out for several minutes. It was the vision that caused me to leave my job and go full-time into ministry with three little children, no place to preach, and no income to speak of. I have never been back.

Those are open visions.

After God got me to the place where the anointing would come and I would depart from my senses, I knew that whatever I received apart from my senses was of God. For years after that, when He taught me the operation of a new gift, He would come in with force and remove me so far from my senses that I became a staggering mess.

During those times I knew what I was receiving was from God. Once the gift developed, the anointing would still come, but I did not get quite so staggering.

It was during this time that God began to teach me about ministering visions, which are the most common. An open vision is when everything disappears. A ministering vision is when God puts a picture on the inside of your spirit.

I can still see you, yet this vision is suspended in front of me and I can see it also. It materializes in my spirit, and I had to learn the difference. When it came, it was usually accompanied by an anointing of God. Under that anointing I knew it was God.

I have ministering visions often. When I walk out into a crowd and look at someone, an organ may materialize in my spirit while I am looking at them. Sometimes I see what is wrong in the organ.

One time David lost the keys. I had just been on a fast. The moment he told me, a vision materialized in my spirit, though I was looking at him. I saw the Coke machine and the top of it. I said, "David, go down to the Coke machine. The keys are on top of it." He had laid them there when he got a Coke, and sure enough, there they were.

Another time I lost my wallet. I started praying and worshiping God, and an inner vision materialized. I saw my suitcase half-open. When I looked inside in the vision, I saw my wallet. I went to the suitcase, opened it, and there it was.

One time I was filling the car with gas, and the Lord said, "Do you want Me to teach you about My voice?" I said yes. Then I saw the amount of the gas in a vision before I saw it naturally. He was teaching me how to know His voice and what visions are like. He does not do that for entertainment. He was teaching me.

I know where these visions come from. They materialize in the ear of my spirit, inside my spirit.

Because I have learned those four methods of communication, I have learned how to shut down. It does not matter who comes into my presence or what is going on. It can be World War III around me, and I can shut down and begin to monitor the ear of my spirit.

I know how to shut my ground down and listen intently to the place in me where He talks.

Sometimes people ask, "How do you do it? Sometimes things are going on around you beyond your control, and then you walk out and minister. Does the anointing come?"

Yes, the anointing comes. But long before the anointing comes, I have learned how to shut down. When I walk out and begin to worship or pray over the Word and the service, I generally shut down completely. I dismiss everything, clear my ground, and the ear of my spirit opens up. From that moment on, you are shut out, and I begin to listen to God.

One of the key factors in walking in the Spirit and developing to hear His voice is not only hearing it, but discerning whether it is Him. I am not saying every time I shut down He talks. Sometimes He does not. But if He does, I know it.

You do not learn this fully until you learn the peace walk.

Before I learned the peace walk, I was at the mercy of the anointing. If the anointing came, God supernaturally cleared my ground and I could hear Him. But if it did not come, I did not know how to shut down and listen.

Peace is a key ingredient to being able to hear God consistently and know when it is Him.

Years ago I was learning how to yield to prophecy and how He spoke English to me. I was working at the mill, worshiping God and asking Him to help me witness to people. Finally He told me that a certain man was going to La Pine, a town eighteen miles from where I lived. We were having a revival there every night.

The voice said, "This man is going to La Pine tonight."

I walked up to him and said, "Since you are going to La Pine tonight, how about dropping in on our meeting?"

He said, "Nothing doing."

I walked away, but after about an hour I could not take it anymore. I went back and asked, "Are you going to La Pine tonight?"

He said, "Yes, I have to pick up a load of lumber."

I said, "Glory to God, I heard Him."

Another time I drove by a racetrack and tried to shut down to hear which horse would win. Unfortunately, that place where He talks to me remained silent.

The key to shutting down and hearing that voice in the middle of the storm is the level of peace you develop. Being able to shut down in pressure, in life-and-death decisions, and hear Him is a major key to the walk of the Spirit.

Sometimes I have offended people without meaning to. When I am introduced to someone for the first time, I automatically begin to shut down. The moment they approach me, I open myself to the ear of the Spirit. Most of the time He gives me a profile.

Those profiles began coming when God purged me enough that I would not hurt people. He had to purge me from rejoicing when someone who came against me failed miserably, got sick, or fell apart.

That "I told you so" spirit is wrong. If you have that, God will not trust you with people because you are not really out for their good.

Once He gets you to the place where the devil cannot really get you to hurt people, and you are out for their good even when they fail, He can trust you with more.

God talks all the time. His silence is not your problem. Your deafness is.

Fasting does not cause God to hear your voice on high. It moves you into a place where you can hear His voice down low.

Wisdom cries in the chief places of concourse, the business intersections, waving her red flags. You have never made a wrong decision that cost your family without wisdom crying out somewhere, saying, "How long will you love simplicity?"

If wisdom cries in business decisions, she certainly cries in your personal life.

If you really want to go to school to hear His voice, His school consists mainly of moving from where you are into a walk of peace.

The second thing consistent with hearing His voice is willingness to obey anything He asks you to do. Why would He come and make His will known to you if you consistently yawn, belch, and go to bed?

If you make a consistent habit of turning Him down, He will stop after a while.

Do what is necessary to enter into peace. Do what is necessary to approach the love of God, where He continues the perfecting process as you love one another and takes you away from torment and fear.

The only reason you would have torment is because you are worried about the present, past, or future. But if God is for you, who can be against you?

Jesus said:

| In the world ye shall have tribulation: but be of good cheer; I have overcome the world.

Who said the storm would not rage around you? He said that in Him you have peace.

The Kingdom of God is not meat and drink, but righteousness, peace, and joy in the Holy Ghost. God has a shortage of storm troopers, people who can go into a storm, hear His voice, put the fire out, and come back out without smelling like smoke.

The ability to shut down in the middle of the storm is incredible because God is right there.

I have found that many things believers do carry too high a price for hearing God's voice. The same place people get ideas to hurt people is where His voice is generated. It is very hard to hear salvation words for a person you are destroying.

How people treat you is not your responsibility, but how you treat them is. Jesus said:

| As ye would that men should do to you, do ye also to them likewise.

He was not saying the people you treat well will always treat you well in return. Many times the people you invest the most in shoot you the hardest.

But how you want to be treated is how you need to treat them. They may not treat you that way, but God will.

Luke 6:38 says:

| Give, and it shall be given unto you...

That is not only about money. It is about anything that costs you in operating in obedience to God. God says, "I will pick up the bill. If you do what I commanded you, I will treat you the way you treated them."

That is what makes you free.

If you develop the capacity not to hurt people from your heart, to forgive your brother his trespasses, then God can trust you with more.

When people come up, sometimes I get a profile. God often lets me know where they are. If they are presenting themselves behind a facade, if they are not who they say they are spiritually, that is usually the first thing He alerts me to.

Then He alerts me to how far I should enter in with them. He does not mind how far I enter in, but at a certain point if they turn and hurt me, it was my choice to go beyond that point.

If I see a lot of potential and an incredible gift in a person, sometimes I go way in with them, and they end up stomping me into the ground. But I do not mind, because I lose some and gain some. When we gain some, the Body of Christ benefits incredibly.

Sometimes when someone is introduced to me, I hear nothing. I can shut down, and the silence of the ear of the spirit is so loud that it drowns out everything everyone is saying. That silence absorbs my mind so that I can hear anything that comes from the spirit.

My best Friend stands right there. He will not let anybody hurt me without me knowing what they are going to do. He is my counselor, my confidant, and my mighty King.

If you let Him, He will also be your business partner. He will be wisdom crying at the chief places of concourse, waving the flag and saying, "Do not go down that avenue of business."

The most valuable thing you possess is the leadership of the Spirit. When God bothers you about something, leave it alone like a hot coal.

Aggressive peace is about three-quarters of walking consistently in the voice of God.

This kind of teaching both slices and heals, and what is irritating about it is that you have an inner witness that it is true.

Jesus said in John 15:

Every branch that beareth fruit, he purgeth it, that it may bring forth more fruit.

Now ye are clean through the word which I have spoken unto you.

The Word of God is the purging process. If you bear fruit, He will purge you so you bear more fruit.

If the message does not both cut and put healing balm on, it is probably not really preaching. Those who only preach the outer limits of the flesh and never deal with the other side are often more interested in something you have than in your soul.

When you edify yourself enough by praying in tongues, the first time the Holy Ghost reaches up, there may be war. But when you get past it, the peace is sweet, and you will be walking with Jesus somewhere you have never walked before.

Preachers used to drive me crazy when they said God spoke to their spirit. I would ask, "Where is your spirit? How did you hear?"

They would say, "God spoke way down deep in my spirit." That is correct in one sense because when the Holy Ghost begins to talk, it feels like it comes from a deep well. But it is so deep within your spirit that it feels like it comes from down here, even though it does not.

Where He talks to you is the spirit of your mind, or your spiritual mind.

When I began to understand where His voice came into existence in me, I was able to shut down the surface level of my mind and monitor the mind of my spirit. I began to listen to the ear of my spirit, where He talks every time.

Once in a while He speaks audibly to the outer ear, and that is different. But when He speaks from inside, His voice comes through the same place, the ear of your spirit.

Visions come from the same place. English comes across the same channel. Revelation comes across the same channel. The inner witness comes across the same channel.

Luke 16:19 says:

There was a certain rich man, which was clothed in purple and fine linen, and fared sumptuously every day.

He loved fine linen, purple, and sumptuous living. God has nothing against that. But God does have something against stepping over the Lazaruses of the world, being drunk on self-indulgence while people die within the sound of your silverware.

There was a beggar named Lazarus laid at his gate, full of sores, desiring to be fed with the crumbs from the rich man's table. The dogs came and licked his sores.

Then Lazarus died and was carried by the angels into Abraham's bosom, the Old Testament promise of justification by faith. The rich man also died and was buried.

Then Scripture says:

And in hell he lift up his eyes, being in torments...

The man's body lay in the grave, yet in hell he lifted up his eyes. That means the spirit man has eyes.

He was in torments. That means the spirit man has emotions.

He saw Abraham and Lazarus. Then he cried:

Father Abraham, have mercy on me, and send Lazarus, that he may dip the tip of his finger in water, and cool my tongue.

We know people in heaven have at least a fingertip, and the rich man had eyes and a tongue. If my spirit man has eyes, a tongue, and a finger, then he must have everything else.

My spiritual hand operates inside my physical hand. I am standing in this natural suit my spirit man has put on so I can operate in the natural world. If you cut off my physical arm, you would not cut off my spiritual arm. It would still be there, but it would not be able to operate in this natural world without a special miracle.

Ronald Coyne had what people called the plastic eye miracle. As a boy, he had lost an eye. T. L. Osborn's sister prayed for him in a meeting, and God gave him sight in his plastic eye.

His mother kept trying to explain, "You do not understand. He has a plastic eye, and God gave him sight through it."

He was challenged by people who thought it was fraud, but the tests showed he could see with no natural eye.

I set a meeting up for him in Oakridge, Oregon, when I was about twenty-eight or twenty-nine. He called volunteers up, and we taped his good eye shut. Then he reached in and popped out the plastic eye. You could not see through it. It was not transparent. Yet when he put it back in, he could see. Without it, he could see.

He opened the socket so we could look back into it. There was no eye. Then with his good eye taped shut, he took a driver's license and read the fine print with no eye.

God did a miracle in reverse. Instead of opening a physically dead eye, He opened Ronald's spiritual eye so he could see into the natural world.

If God did the same kind of miracle with a man whose legs had been cut off, and that man came walking across the room, it would make people understand that we really do have an inner man. The inner man operates through the physical man.

If I stepped out of my body and God did a miracle so you could see both my physical man and spirit man, my physical finger would be made of cells, atoms, compounds, and flesh. But if my spirit man held up his finger, what would that finger be made of?

It is made of spirit.

I am a human being. I am a spirit, and I have a body. My spirit finger is made of a spiritual substance, the kind of substance God creates eternal beings from, such as angels.

The spirit man fits the physical body not merely finger to finger, but cell to cell.

That is what makes you different from the animal kingdom. God created you in His family and in His class and gave you, at your discretion, the ability to procreate. Through the law of Genesis, He gave you power to bring eternal creatures into existence.

When does the baby's spirit come into existence? At the moment that little living cell unites and begins to divide, that spirit comes into existence through the law of Genesis and begins to grow cell for cell at the same rate.

If the cell is one minute old and has experienced its first division, that child is going to heaven and will grow up there.

If my spirit man has a mind, hands, and eyes, it would be ridiculous for God to talk to my belly. He talks to my mind, specifically to my spiritual mind, my inner man.

There is a place where this communication comes into existence every time. It is the place where the Holy Spirit resides in you as your Teacher.

The Holy Spirit has come as the mighty Teacher of your human spirit, which received a new nature and is no longer a power plant for death. It now has the nature of God and fellowship with God. He has sent you the Teacher of all teachers to bring forth everything you are in your new creation.

Your soul is not more powerful than your spirit. It never has been. Your soul is automatically conquered when you let the Holy Spirit bring your spirit forward.

The same place He talks to me, gives me profiles, and prophecies through me is the same place He communicates by revelation. It is the same place He opens the Word and teaches me. It is the same place that power rises and says, "Peace, be still," to my soul.

There is a mind of my spirit. Science calls something like it the subconscious mind and already knows it is capable of much more than the natural mind. But you have a regenerated spiritual mind thinking with the nature of God, with a Teacher there ready to illuminate and enlighten.

If you let Him bring that forward, your soul does not have a chance. It is not that your soul is more powerful than your spirit; it is that you will not bring your spirit forward to conquer.

In the prayer closet, when God wanted me to understand this, He slipped me into a vision. For the first time I saw my body, my soul, my spirit, and the Holy Spirit. I saw what happened when I prayed in tongues. I saw what happened when He communicated revelation knowledge. I saw what happened when He became my Teacher. I saw what happened when the soul shut down and peace came forward.

He magnifies the nature of the born-again spirit until it dominates every facet of your being. It can make you a millionaire, and it can also make you the kind of person who will give it away.

By the time you get into enough fellowship with Him to hear how to make the million, you may not care whether you make it. You will be off dancing with Him, getting people healed and watching blind eyes open.

Some people are born to make the money. They may not want to go with you; they just want to give you a check.

I will take it.

We need to stop here.